

Deliverable 1- Initial Problem Statement, Scoping and Solution Proposal

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Company Name: Harborview Services

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Overview:

Our team will be advising the New York-based business: ExcellentNYC, a toy merchandiser retailer.

Problem:

Currently, ExcellentNYC has 38 employees and does not have a standardized management system in place of recording hours and attendance. This leads to creating inefficient service since it creates scheduling conflicts, misplaced hours, inefficient staffing, and errors in payroll. These issues not only take away valuable time from managers dealing with disputes but also discourage employees from being prompt and consistent since management struggles with their system.

Proposed Solution:

The proposed information system utilizes Microsoft Access to create a timesheet and attendance management system for its employees. The system will have records of employees and time clocked in and out to record hours for payroll, record sick days/PTO, avoid inefficient staffing, and avoid scheduling conflicts. Implementing this solution will decrease any human error to decrease payroll and hours calculated issues to increase overall productivity. It will also create a standardized system that can be expanded further in the future to other locations.

Business Value:

Currently, ExcellentNYC has no standardized information system in place to manage its 38 employees. Implementing this system will create management efficiency, like accurate time recording, updated payroll, and decreased time conflicts.

Business Problem / Lead Identification:

While working with the client, Shi Wei Zheng will be our business expert. He was a previous employee at ExcellentNYC. The company's employee scheduling was done manually by the manager, causing confusion, and without a clock-in/clock-out system recording, it led to inconsistent schedules, no single source of truth, calculation errors in pay, and high administrative overhead. If an issue is not resolved in the long run, it might lead to financial issues.

Effective Data

Time Period Reviewed: Last 3 months

Missing Hours

Average missing hours per month: 72 hours

- Total missing hours over 3 months: 432 hours
- Estimated cost of missing hours: \$9,500–\$11,000

Scheduling Conflicts

- Average scheduling conflicts per month: 18
- Total conflicts over 3 months: 108 conflicts

Effects

- 22% of shifts required last-minute changes
- Managers spent an average of 6–8 hours per week fixing schedules

Function of System:

The information system, which will be used to manage scheduling and tracking hours, will be used by both employees and the management team. We will create preset tables, relationships, and queries to reach the goals. Importantly, using forms, we will create a friendly GUI for employees to interact with.

Process Flow:

Employees will use a form to enter the time they clock in and clock out using a unique ID. Employees can also request days out/schedule changes. This data will be stored in a relational database. Management, like store managers, can use queries to generate reports to evaluate payroll, approve/deny when employees will be out (PTO/sick days), and avoid scheduling conflicts if they arise.